

EXPORT HORTICULTURE PROJECT

Preliminary Investment Concept

1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

The project seeks to establish an export-oriented horticulture enterprise focused on:

- high-value crop production,
- aggregation from partner farmers,
- export packaging,
- cold-chain logistics,
- and international market supply.

The business aims to supply premium fresh produce to international buyers while building a reliable and scalable agricultural export platform.

Target export regions include:

- Europe,
 - Middle East,
 - and regional African premium markets.
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2. THE PROBLEM

The horticulture export sector faces several operational gaps:

- inconsistent product quality,
- fragmented farmer supply,
- poor cold-chain systems,
- post-harvest losses,
- certification challenges,
- and unreliable export coordination.

Many small farmers lack:

- export market access,
- compliance support,
- irrigation infrastructure,
- financing,
- and proper packaging systems.

As a result:

- significant produce value is lost,
 - export standards are difficult to maintain,
 - and international demand remains underserved.
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3. THE OPPORTUNITY

Global demand for fresh African produce continues to grow due to:

- increasing health-conscious consumption,
- demand for off-season supply,
- expansion of supermarket chains,
- and rising international food distribution networks.

Kenya remains strategically positioned because of:

- favorable climate conditions,
- established air cargo connections,
- experienced agricultural labor,
- and strong horticulture export recognition.

High-potential export crops include:

- avocados,
 - French beans,
 - chili,
 - capsicum,
 - herbs,
 - baby corn,
 - snow peas,
 - mangoes,
 - and passion fruits.
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4. BUSINESS MODEL

The project will operate through five core activities:

A. Commercial Production

Direct cultivation of export-grade horticultural crops using modern irrigation and quality management systems.

B. Contract Farming Network

Partnering with out-grower farmers through structured supply agreements and technical support.

C. Aggregation & Quality Control

Centralized collection, grading, sorting, and quality assurance systems to meet export standards.

D. Cold Chain & Logistics

Cold storage, refrigerated transport, and export logistics coordination to minimize post-harvest losses.

E. Export & Distribution

Supplying international buyers, exporters, distributors, and supermarket supply chains.

5. TARGET MARKET

Primary Markets:

- European fresh produce importers
- Middle Eastern distributors
- International supermarket supply chains
- Export wholesalers

Secondary Markets:

- Regional premium retail chains
 - Hotels and hospitality buyers
 - Food processors
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6. COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

The project intends to differentiate itself through:

- export-grade quality control,
- structured farmer networks,
- reliable cold-chain systems,
- irrigation-backed production,

- traceability systems,
- and compliance-focused operations.

The project also aims to build strong relationships with international buyers through consistency and transparent supply systems.

7. EXPORT COMPLIANCE & CERTIFICATION

The project intends to align with international export standards including:

- GlobalG.A.P.
- phytosanitary compliance,
- traceability systems,
- food safety standards,
- and responsible farming practices.

Future certifications may include:

- organic certification,
 - fair-trade standards,
 - and sustainability-focused export programs.
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8. CAPITAL REQUIREMENTS

Initial investment will support:

- irrigation infrastructure,
- greenhouse systems,
- packhouse development,
- cold storage,
- export logistics,
- certification processes,
- and operational working capital.

Indicative funding requirement:

USD 100,000 – USD 1,000,000 depending on scale and export capacity.

9. USE OF FUNDS

Funds will support:

- land preparation
 - irrigation systems
 - greenhouse infrastructure
 - packhouse construction
 - cold storage systems
 - farm inputs
 - export compliance
 - transport logistics
 - staffing and technical operations
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10. GROWTH POTENTIAL

Future expansion opportunities include:

- direct export licensing,
 - value-added processing,
 - branded fresh produce,
 - dried fruit processing,
 - expanded out-grower networks,
 - and regional export hubs.
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11. ESG & SUSTAINABILITY

The project aims to support:

- climate-smart agriculture,
- efficient water use,
- youth employment,
- farmer inclusion,
- reduced food waste,
- and sustainable export supply chains.

The business also seeks to support local farmers through structured market access and technical capacity building.

12. CURRENT STATUS

Current activities include:

- export market assessment,
 - buyer identification,
 - land and irrigation evaluation,
 - farmer engagement,
 - and operational planning.
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13. INVESTMENT & PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITY

The project seeks:

- strategic investors,
- export buyers,
- cold-chain partners,
- agricultural technology providers,
- irrigation partners,
- logistics collaborators,
- and international distribution partners.

The long-term objective is to establish a scalable export horticulture platform capable of supplying premium international markets from East Africa.